

Adam Kliegman

Software Engineer - Design Systems • Frontend Architecture • Accessibility • AI Products

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Summary

I'm a full-stack engineer who lives on the frontend and cares most about design systems, with more than 13 years across engineering, product leadership, and UX spent building the shared foundations other engineers ship on.

Experience

MagicSchool AI • EdTech • 8M+ active users • \$45M Series B • B2B/B2C

Senior Software Engineer • Jan 2025 to Present

- Founded Spellbook, the design system for an AI-native platform serving more than 8 million educators, and own the frontend architecture beneath it: 86 components, semantic design tokens, layout primitives, and documented usage guidance, at 100% adoption across a 50-engineer organization with redundant UI code cut by half.
- Lead the cross-functional design-system guild across engineers and designers company-wide, setting governance, the contribution model, adoption strategy, documentation standards, and the long-term roadmap, and reviewing inbound contributions from product teams.
- Define how engineers work with coding agents: wrote the conventions engineers and agents both follow, and contributed to the MCP server that exposes the design system's components, tokens, guidelines, and usage validation to AI coding tools, so generated code is checked against the same source of truth humans use.
- Architect the token layer as DTCG JSON split into primitives and role-based semantic aliases that components reference, with a light and a dark value required for every color token and the theme generated from that single source behind a build-failing freshness check, so every new surface ships correct in both modes.
- Set the engineering norms the frontend organization runs on and make them enforceable in CI: an accessibility assertion required for every component to merge, architectural decision records for settled questions, and flag-gated release practice carried through to retiring the flag and its dead branch.
- Own the documentation and sandbox tooling engineers learn the system from: Storybook with a documentation contract requiring worked dos and don'ts for every exported component, a combinatorial prop, theme, and viewport sandbox, and a generated component manifest that feeds both the docs and the agent tools.
- Deliver a WYSIWYG quiz builder that lets educators generate, edit, reorder, validate, and refine AI-produced assessment content within a single editing surface, designed and built end to end.
- Led the migration off a fragmented Material UI codebase onto a single React and TypeScript foundation of ShadCN, Radix UI, Tailwind CSS 4, and Storybook, sequencing the rollout across teams and retiring the legacy stack entirely without pausing feature delivery.
- Own the shared interaction primitives whole classes of workflow depend on, including data grid, table, pagination, command palette, multi-select, autocomplete, and the filter-chip family, then migrate product surfaces onto them.
- Drive application-wide accessibility architecture producing an exceptional VPAT assessment, including reflow and focus behavior at 400% zoom, landmarks, and screen-reader semantics that automated checks do not catch.
- Architect AI product surfaces end to end, including streaming model responses, structured outputs validated against schema, tool calling, retry and fallback paths, and human-in-the-loop review so educators steer generation rather than accept it.
- Mentor engineers and designers on component design, accessibility, and system thinking, and uphold the standards through design and code review.

Technology: TypeScript, React, Next.js, Vercel, Supabase, ShadCN, Radix UI, Tailwind CSS, Storybook, Vitest, Playwright, PostgreSQL, Vercel AI SDK, Anthropic and OpenAI APIs, MCP, Streaming UI, Structured Outputs, Evals

RubyLaw • 20 of the 50 Largest U.S. Law Firms • Legal MarTech SaaS • B2B2C

Software Engineer III • Jul 2023 to Jul 2024

- Engineered a Figma-based design system, reusable React component library, starter toolkit, document-generation system, and content-management integrations for the platform's law-firm clients.
- Translated sophisticated brand systems into reusable component APIs without sacrificing responsive behavior, accessibility, performance, or visual quality.
- Built configurable, polished, and WCAG-compliant websites, blogs, intranets, and extranets using a shared component architecture.

Technology: JavaScript, React, Sass, CSS Modules, Storybook, Express, Node.js, Elasticsearch, Puppeteer

Demyst Data • FinTech SaaS • Acquired by Feedzai (2025) • B2B

Director of Product Management • Mar 2021 to Jan 2023

Senior Product Manager • Oct 2019 to Mar 2021

- Architected and personally engineered the customer platform frontend while managing a globally distributed team of eight, and led the transformation of Demyst into an API-first SaaS platform for self-service data discovery, integration, and management.
- Defined frontend architecture, information hierarchy, interaction patterns, and complex enterprise data-management experiences spanning discovery, configuration, permissions, governance, and billing.
- Built an atomic design system used across the company's products, improving interface consistency, accessibility, and engineering velocity.
- Led engineering for a company-wide rebrand and marketing-site rebuild that increased daily impressions by approximately 6,000 and doubled the inbound lead pipeline.
- Bridged product strategy, UX, frontend engineering, data science, and backend development to turn technically complex workflows into understandable user experiences.

Technology: JavaScript, React, Redux, LESS, Zeplin, Ruby on Rails, Python, Sklearn, REST, PostgreSQL, Jest

Noodle • EdTech • Founded by John Katzman (Princeton Review, 2U) • B2B2C/B2C

Sr. Product Manager • Feb 2018 to Mar 2019

Lead Product Engineer • Jan 2016 to Feb 2018

UX/UI Engineer • Oct 2014 to Jan 2016

- Designed and engineered an end-to-end tutoring marketplace and operations platform spanning discovery, enrollment, scheduling, instruction, communication, and administration.
- Helped double year-over-year revenue to more than \$2 million, grow monthly traffic by approximately 5,000 visitors, and reduce the average sales cycle by half.
- Translated the needs of students, educators, families, and internal teams into intuitive workflows and practical technical solutions.

Technology: JavaScript, Flask/Jinja, Sass, MySQL, Firebase, REST, jQuery

Earlier Experience

Shoplet • eCommerce • \$50M Annual Revenue • B2C

Frontend Developer • 2013 to 2014

- Led UI implementation for a brand refresh and developed eCommerce experiences supporting approximately 20,000 daily visitors.

Tigerspike • Mobile App Development • Acquired by Concentrix (2017) • Agency

Business Analyst • 2012 to 2013

- Supported technical product strategy and enterprise solution development for Fortune 100 clients, helping secure more than \$5 million in new business.

Technical Skills

Design Systems and UX: Component Architecture, Component APIs, Design Tokens, Style Dictionary, Theming and Multi-Brand Support, Storybook, Visual Regression Testing, Figma, Atomic Design, Adoption and Migration Strategy, Responsive Design, Interaction Design, Information Architecture, WYSIWYG Interfaces

Languages and Frontend: TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, React, Next.js, React Server Components, Suspense, Redux, Zustand, TanStack Query, Zod, React Aria, ShadCN, Radix UI, Material UI, Tailwind CSS, CSS Modules, Sass

Accessibility and Quality: WCAG 2.2 AA, Section 508, VPAT, Semantic HTML, ARIA, Keyboard Navigation, Focus Management, Screen-Reader Support, axe-core, Vitest, React Testing Library, Jest, Playwright, Cypress, Lighthouse, Core Web Vitals

AI Engineering: LLM Application Development, Anthropic and OpenAI APIs, Vercel AI SDK, Streaming Responses, Structured Outputs and JSON Schema, Tool and Function Calling, MCP, Agent-Facing Developer Tooling, Prompt Engineering, Retrieval-Augmented Generation, Evals, Guardrails and Content Safety, Human-in-the-Loop Workflows, Claude Code

Developer Experience and Architecture: Monorepos, Turborepo, pnpm, Changesets, Feature Flags, Incremental Migration, Trunk-Based Development, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, ESLint, Vite, Webpack, Sentry, Technical Standards and RFCs, Architectural Decision Records

Backend and Platform: Node.js, Express, REST APIs, GraphQL, Webhooks, Edge and Serverless Functions, PostgreSQL, Supabase, Row-Level Security, MySQL, Redis, Elasticsearch, Django, Flask, Ruby on Rails, Vercel, AWS

Education

Silicon Valley Product Group

Product Leaders Academy • 2020

University of Wisconsin–Madison

B.S. in Psychology